Mandatory quiz sessions below a placement cutoff: a regression discontinuity study

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Abstract

Students scoring just below a mathematics placement cutoff had to attend weekly quiz sessions. Among 1,530 students near the cutoff, the pass rate was 7 percentage points higher for those required to attend.

1. Methods

Design: sharp regression discontinuity around a placement-test cutoff. Participants: 1,530 students whose placement scores fell within the chosen bandwidth around the cutoff. Treatment: mandatory weekly quiz sessions for students below the cutoff. Outcome: passing the first mathematics course.

2. Results

At the cutoff, mandatory quiz sessions raised the pass rate by 7 percentage points (95% CI 2 to 12).

3. Limitations

The estimate is local to students near the cutoff and may not apply to higher-achieving students.

Fictional paper generated to test evidence-table extraction. Authors, journal, data and results are invented.